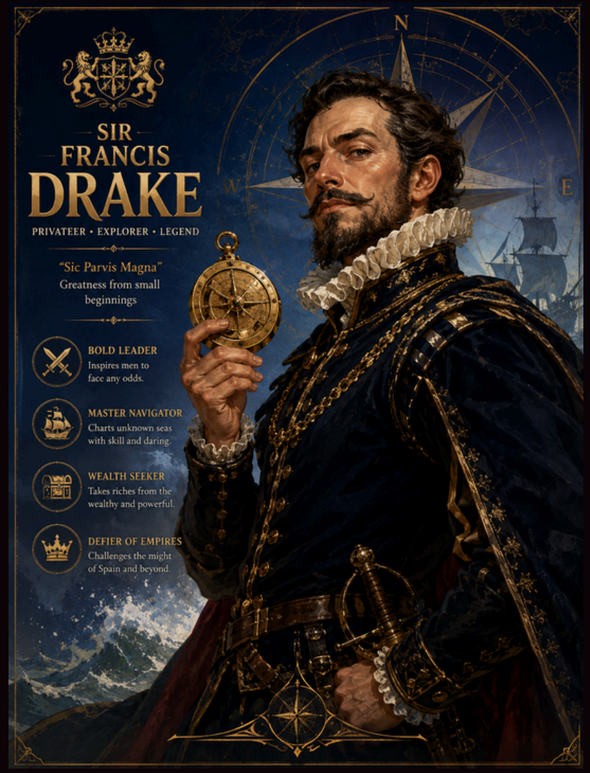
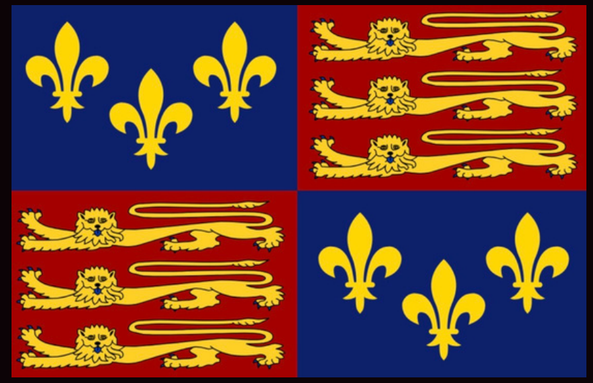
ENDLAND

Leader — Sir Francis Drake (c. 1540–1596)





Role: Explorer, privateer, and naval commander
Patron: Queen Elizabeth I

Drake led the first English expedition to circumnavigate the world (1577–1580). He explored the Pacific coast of North America and claimed land in present-day California for England as New Albion. He later served as Vice Admiral against the Spanish Armada in 1588

Leader Abilities
1. Circumnavigator
   - Historical basis: Completed an English circumnavigation of the world.
   - Game Buff: Exploration ships gain +20% movement speed and +20% exploration range.
2. Privateer's Fortune
   - Historical basis: Drake operated as an English privateer against Spanish shipping.
   - Game Buff: Defeating enemy trade ships grants bonus Gold.

National Characteristic
Naval Exploration & Privateering
   - Strong naval exploration
   - Privateering and attacks on enemy trade
   - Overseas settlements and trade networks
   - Permanent English settlement at Jamestown, Virginia, established in 1607

National Buff — Maritime Ambition
   - Ships gain +10% exploration range
   - Trade income +10%

Special Unit — English Privateer
Role: Fast naval raider
Historical basis: Privateering was an important part of English maritime warfare during the Elizabethan period.

FRANCE

Leader — Samuel de Champlain (c. 1574–1635)



Role: Explorer, navigator, cartographer, soldier, and colonial administrator

Champlain explored and mapped northeastern North America and founded Quebec in 1608, helping establish permanent French colonization in the St. Lawrence region. He also formed important alliances with Indigenous peoples.

Leader Abilities

1. Master Cartographer
   - Historical basis: Champlain produced detailed maps of northeastern North America.
   - Game Buff: Exploration reveals +25% more map area.
2. Founder of Quebec
   - Historical basis: Founded Quebec in 1608.
   - Game Buff: Newly founded settlements receive +20% initial Defense.

National Characteristic

River Exploration & Fur Trade

- St. Lawrence River and Great Lakes were important routes
- Strong inland exploration
- Fur trade and cooperation with Indigenous peoples
- Expansion through river networks

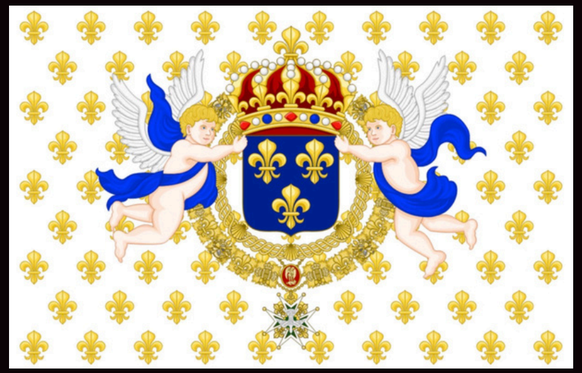
National Buff — New France

- Movement on rivers +20%
- Fur-trade income +15%

Special Unit — Coureur des bois

Role: Exploration and trade unit

Historical basis: Independent French forest traders who travelled deep into North America and participated in the fur trade.



SPAIN

Leader — Hernán Cortés (1485–1547)



Role: Conquistador and military commander

Cortés led the Spanish campaign against the Mexica (Aztec) Empire. The fall of Tenochtitlan in 1521 depended not only on Spanish soldiers but also on large Indigenous allied forces, particularly the Tlaxcalans.



Leader Abilities

1. Indigenous Alliances

- **Historical basis: Cortés relied heavily on Indigenous allies during the conquest.**
- **Game Buff: Allied Indigenous units gain +10% combat strength.**

2. Conquest of Mexico

- **Historical basis: Cortés led the campaign that resulted in the fall of Tenochtitlan.**
- **Game Buff: Expeditionary forces gain +15% attack when attacking major settlements.**

National Characteristic

Conquest & Resource Extraction

- **Military expeditions**
- **Large territorial expansion**
- **Precious-metal extraction**
- **Colonial administration**
- **Missionary activity**

National Buff — Imperial Conquest

- **Capturing major settlements grants bonus Gold**
- **Gold-producing territories provide +15% income**

Special Unit — Conquistador

Role: Elite expeditionary unit

Historical basis: Spanish soldiers and expedition leaders involved in exploration and conquest in the Americas.

NETHERLANDS

Leader — Adriaen Block (c. 1567–1627)



Role: Merchant, navigator, and explorer

Block explored and charted northeastern North America during 1611–1614. His 1614 map was an important early Dutch map of the region and helped develop Dutch commercial interest in New Netherland.

Historical note: Unlike England, France, Spain, and Portugal, the Dutch Republic was not ruled by a king during this period. Dutch overseas expansion was strongly connected to merchants and chartered companies.

Leader Abilities

1. Coastal Cartographer
   - Historical basis: Block explored and mapped the northeastern North American coast.
   - Game Buff: Coastal exploration reveals +30% more map area.
2. Trade Pioneer
   - Historical basis: Dutch exploration was closely connected with commercial opportunities, especially the fur trade.
   - Game Buff: Newly discovered trade resources provide +20% trade income.

National Characteristic

Commerce & Trading Companies

- Strong merchant networks
- Trading posts and ports
- Fur trade
- Chartered companies such as the Dutch West India Company
- New Netherland was part of the Dutch Atlantic network

National Buff — Merchant Power

- Trade income +20%
- Trading Posts cost 15% fewer resources
- Ports generate additional Gold

Special Unit — Dutch Fluyt

Role: High-capacity trade ship

Historical basis: The fluyt was a Dutch cargo vessel associated with the commercial expansion of the Dutch Republic.



PORTUGAL

Leader — Pedro Álvares Cabral (c. 1467/68–1520)



Role: Navigator and expedition commander
Patron: King Manuel I of Portugal

Cabral commanded a Portuguese fleet that sailed in 1500 on an expedition toward India. The fleet reached the coast of Brazil in April 1500, where Cabral claimed the territory for the Portuguese Crown before continuing toward India.

Leader Abilities

1. Ocean Navigator
   - Historical basis: Cabral commanded a large ocean-going expedition between the Atlantic and Indian Ocean.
   - Game Buff: Ocean-going ships gain +20% exploration range.
2. Brazilian Landfall
   - Historical basis: Cabral's 1500 expedition reached the Brazilian coast and claimed the territory for Portugal.
   - Game Buff: The first Portuguese colony established in a newly discovered region receives a small economic bonus.

National Characteristic

Oceanic Exploration & Maritime Trade
- Long-distance ocean navigation
- Overseas trade networks
- Early colonial expansion
- Brazil became a major Portuguese possession

National Buff — Age of Discovery
- Ocean exploration range +25%
- Long-distance voyage attrition -10%
- Overseas trade income +15%

Special Unit — Portuguese Caravel

Role: Fast exploration vessel

Historical basis: Caravels were important vessels in Portuguese exploration and were particularly useful for navigating Atlantic coastal waters and difficult winds.

